SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #31 · WORTH AND CLASS

“People with money are better than me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Wealth often comes with confidence, polish, and access, and those can look like superiority. If we grew up with less, were treated as lesser, or were taught to defer to the wealthy, we may keep that stance for life. Media and workplaces can reinforce it by treating wealth as a measure of competence and worth.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture says plainly that God does not show favoritism. Paul writes that there is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, for we are all one in Christ Jesus. James asks, “Has not God chosen those who are poor in the eyes of the world to be rich in faith?” and Paul reminds us that God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong. Before God, wealth does not rank people. We stand on level ground, with the same Maker and the same need of grace.

> *“For God does not show favoritism”* (Romans 2:11).

Also see

> “There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus” (Galatians 3:28).

> “Listen, my beloved brothers: Has not God chosen the poor of this world to be rich in faith and to inherit the kingdom He promised those who love Him?” (James 2:5).

> “But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong” (1 Corinthians 1:27).

> “Then Peter began to speak: ‘I now truly understand that God does not show favoritism.’” (Acts 10:34).

Common self-statements

- They are smarter than I am.
- I should defer to people with more.
- I am not in their league.
- They deserve more respect.
- I am less because I have less.
- I should not speak up around them.

Common logical errors

- Social comparison: Measuring my worth against someone’s wealth.
- Halo effect: Assuming that wealth means they are better in every way.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling small and concluding that I am small.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing people as either high or low.

Challenging questions

- What do I actually know about this person beyond their income?
- Where did I learn to rank people by money?
- What does God say about how He sees rich and poor?
- What strengths and gifts do I have that money cannot buy?

- How do I behave when I believe someone is “better” than me?
- What would it look like to treat wealthy people as equals?

Truth summary

> God does not rank people by money. I am made in His image and loved by Him as much as anyone. I can respect others without bowing to them and can stand on the level ground Christ gives.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Prejudice
- Worldly
- Pride
- Humility

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God’s loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

My Plan for Replacing "People with money are better than me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People with money are better than me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn to rank people by money?
- ☐ What gifts do I bring?
- ☐ How does God see rich and poor?
- ☐ How do I act when I feel "less than"?
- ☐ What would equal footing look like?
- ☐ What is one fact that corrects this belief?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God shows no favoritism.
- ☐ Money does not make a person better.
- ☐ I am one in Christ with everyone.
- ☐ I have gifts money cannot buy.
- ☐ I can respect people without shrinking.
- ☐ I stand on level ground before God.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Romans 2:11
  "For God does not show favoritism."
- ☐ Galatians 3:28
  "There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ James 2:5
  "Listen, my beloved brothers: Has not God chosen the poor of this world to be rich in faith and to inherit the kingdom He promised those who love Him?"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Level ground: Each week, write one situation in which you felt "less than" and one fact that corrects it.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Galatians 3:28 becomes: "Sarah can write: "We are all one in Christ, so I stand on level ground.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- ☐ Write your gifts. List five gifts or strengths you bring to any room.
- ☐ Practice equal eye contact. In your next conversation with someone more wealthy, hold steady eye contact and speak as an equal.
- ☐ Learn one person's story. Ask a question about their path, not just their position.
- ☐ Read Galatians 3:28 aloud. Say it each morning for a week.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People with money are better than me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment on level ground
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People with money are better than me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You show no favoritism. Free me from believing that people with money are better than I am. Help me see myself and others as You do, and to stand with humble confidence. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #32 · WORTH AND CLASS

“Where I come from makes me less.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

A neighborhood, a family name, a region, an accent, or a family’s history can be treated as a mark against us. Teasing, being passed over, or feeling like an outsider at school or work can leave a lasting sense of being less. Some people try to hide where they came from, and others carry a quiet shame.

What Scripture teaches

When Philip told Nathanael about Jesus, Nathanael asked, “Can anything good come from Nazareth?” and Philip answered, “Come and see.” God often brings good from small and overlooked places. David was the youngest son in the field, and Peter says that God does not show favoritism. The psalmist says that God knew us when we were woven together in secret, before anyone could attach a label to us. Our origin is not our value.

> *“‘Can anything good come from Nazareth?’ Nathanael asked. ‘Come and see,’ said Philip”* (John 1:46).

Also see

> “Then Peter began to speak: ‘I now truly understand that God does not show favoritism.’” (Acts 10:34).

> “‘Before I formed you in the womb I knew you, and before you were born I set you apart and appointed you as a prophet to the nations.’” (Jeremiah 1:5).

> “But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong” (1 Corinthians 1:27).

> “My frame was not hidden from You when I was made in secret, when I was woven together in the depths of the earth” (Psalm 139:15).

Common self-statements

- People from where I come from do not amount to much.
- I should hide where I grew up.
- I will never fit in.
- My background is a mark against me.
- My accent gives me away.
- I come from nothing.

Common logical errors

- Stereotyping: Accepting someone else’s label for my background.
- Overgeneralizing: Letting a few unkind experiences define the whole.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling ashamed and concluding that my background is shameful.
- Mental filter: Seeing only the disadvantages of my origins.

Challenging questions

- What was good about the place and people I come from?
- Who taught me to be ashamed, and what did they gain?

- What strengths did I develop because of where I grew up?
- What does God say about origins and worth?
- What would it look like to honor my background and still grow?
- Who could I tell my story to?

Truth summary

> Where I come from is part of my story, not a measure of my worth. Good can come from small places, and God knew me before anyone labeled me. I can tell my story with honesty and dignity.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Prejudice
- Guilt/Shame
- Humility
- Love, By God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Judgmental

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Hello My Name Is — Matthew West
God's redeemed-child identity challenges labels of regret and defeat.

Dear Younger Me — MercyMe
Past wounds and choices do not have to become a person's permanent identity.

How Great Thou Art — Jordan Smith
This classic hymn connects God's greatness, Christ's sacrifice, and future hope.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Where I come from makes me less"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Where I come from makes me less." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What was good about where I come from?
- ☐ Who taught me to feel ashamed?
- ☐ What strengths did I gain?
- ☐ What does God say about my origin?
- ☐ How can I honor my roots?
- ☐ Who can I tell my story to?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My origin is not my worth.
- ☐ God knew me before I was born.
- ☐ Good can come from small places.
- ☐ My background gave me strengths.
- ☐ I can honor where I come from.
- ☐ I do not have to hide.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **John 1:46**
  "'Can anything good come from Nazareth?' Nathanael asked. 'Come and see,' said Philip."
- ☐ **Jeremiah 1:5**
  "'Before I formed you in the womb I knew you, and before you were born I set you apart and appointed you as a prophet to the nations.'"
- ☐ **Psalm 139:15**
  "My frame was not hidden from You when I was made in secret, when I was woven together in the depths of the earth."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] A strength from my roots: Each week, write one strength or value that comes from where you grew up.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, John 1:46 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Good can come from small places, and God knew me before anyone labeled me.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] List what was good. Write five good things about your family, community, or upbringing.
- [ ] Name the shame. Write what you were taught to feel ashamed of and who taught it.
- [ ] Tell your story. Share a part of your story with a trusted friend.
- [ ] Honor your roots. Do something that celebrates where you came from, such as a favorite food, a call, or a visit.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Where I come from makes me less": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A root I honor
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Where I come from makes me less.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You knew me before I was born. Free me from shame about where I come from. Help me see the good in my story and tell it with honesty and dignity. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #33 · WORTH AND CLASS

"I don't belong among successful people."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Walking into a conference room, a neighborhood, a church gathering, or a social event where everyone seems more polished can bring a sudden sense of being an imposter. People who moved up from humble beginnings often describe it. We can feel that someone will soon "find out," and so we stay quiet or stay away.

What Scripture teaches

Paul writes that we are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of God's household. We are all sons of God through faith in Christ Jesus. Paul also says, "Accept one another, then, just as Christ accepted you." God settles the lonely in families. Belonging in the family of God does not depend on being impressive, and the same welcome applies in every room we are called into.

> *"Therefore you are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of God's household"* (Ephesians 2:19).

Also see

> "Accept one another, then, just as Christ accepted you, in order to bring glory to God" (Romans 15:7).

> "You are all sons of God through faith in Christ Jesus" (Galatians 3:26).

> "God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land" (Psalm 68:6).

> "But you are a chosen people, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people for God's own possession, to proclaim the virtues of Him who called you out of darkness into His marvelous light" (1 Peter 2:9).

Common self-statements

- I am an imposter and they will find out.
- I do not belong in this room.
- They are on a different level than I am.
- I will say something wrong.
- I should stay where I am comfortable.
- I got here by luck.

Common logical errors

- Imposter thinking: Believing that I am fooling people about my ability.
- Mind reading: Assuming others see me as out of place.
- Discounting the positive: Dismissing my accomplishments as luck.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling out of place and concluding that I am.

Challenging questions

- What qualified me to be in this room?
- When have I felt like an outsider and later found I belonged?

- What do I assume others think about me?
- What does God say about my belonging?
- What would I say to a friend who felt this way?
- What is one small way I could take my place?

Truth summary

> I belong because God has welcomed me, and my invitation to a place is not a mistake. Success is not the ticket to belonging. I can walk into rooms with humility and quiet confidence and trust that I have something to offer.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Loneliness
- Church
- Friendship
- Humility

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

Softly and Tenderly — Kristyn Getty with Vince Gill, Ellie Holcomb and Sierra Hull
This older hymn pictures Christ's gracious invitation to return rather than hide in shame.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I don't belong among successful people"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I don't belong among successful people." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What qualifies me to be here?
- ☐ When have I felt out of place and later belonged?
- ☐ What do I fear others think?
- ☐ What does God say about my belonging?
- ☐ What can I offer?
- ☐ Who might be a friend in the room?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am welcomed by God.
- ☐ Belonging does not require impressiveness.
- ☐ I earned my place.
- ☐ Others feel out of place, too.
- ☐ I have something to offer.
- ☐ I can walk in with humble confidence.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Ephesians 2:19
  "Therefore you are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of God's household."
- ☐ Romans 15:7
  "Accept one another, then, just as Christ accepted you, in order to bring glory to God."
- ☐ Psalm 68:6
  "God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ A place I took: Each week, note one time you stayed in a room where you felt out of place and what happened.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Ephesians 2:19 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am a member of God's household, so I belong wherever He sends me.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Loneliness" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- ☐ List your qualifications. Write the work, training, or character that earned your place.
- ☐ Prepare one contribution. Before a gathering, plan one question or comment to offer.
- ☐ Find an ally. Look for one person who is friendly or who feels like an outsider too.
- ☐ Pray before entering. Pray Ephesians 2:19 before a hard room.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I don't belong among successful people": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A place I took
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I don't belong among successful people.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You have made me a member of Your household. Quiet the voice that says I do not belong. Help me walk into every room with humility and quiet confidence. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #34 · WORTH AND CLASS

“My clothes, car, or home show my worth.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Appearances can feel like a language everyone reads. A parent who dressed up for the neighbors, a school where brands mattered, or a workplace where the car in the parking lot sent a message can teach us to treat possessions as proof of value. This can lead to overspending, quiet shame about what we lack, or judgment of others by what they own.

What Scripture teaches

God told Samuel, “Man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.” Peter writes that true beauty should not come from outward adornment such as fine clothes, but from the unfading beauty of a gentle and quiet spirit, which is precious in God’s sight. Jesus said that the poor widow put in more than all the others, because she gave out of her poverty all she had. Our worth is not displayed on the outside.

> *“But the LORD said to Samuel, ‘Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.’”* (1 Samuel 16:7).

Also see

> “Your beauty should not come from outward adornment, such as braided hair or gold jewelry or fine clothes, but from the inner disposition of your heart, the unfading beauty of a gentle and quiet spirit, which is precious in God’s sight” (1 Peter 3:3–4).

> “‘Truly I tell you,’ He said, ‘this poor widow has put in more than all the others. For they all contributed out of their surplus, but she out of her poverty has put in all she had to live on.’” (Luke 21:3–4).

> “And why do you worry about clothes? Consider how the lilies of the field grow: They do not labor or spin” (Matthew 6:28).

> “And He said to them, ‘Watch out! Guard yourselves against every form of greed, for one’s life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions.’” (Luke 12:15).

Common self-statements

- People judge me by what I drive.
- If my house looks small, so am I.
- I have to dress the part to be taken seriously.
- Nice things prove I have made it.
- Having less shows I am less.
- I would be embarrassed if people saw my home.

Common logical errors

- Mind reading: Assuming people judge me by my things.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling ashamed of my car and concluding I am less.
- Labeling: Treating possessions as a label for me.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing myself as either impressive or a failure.

Challenging questions

- What do I try to say with my clothes, car, or home?
- Who am I trying to impress, and why?
- What has the pressure to look successful cost me?
- Whom do I admire, and is it for what they own?
- What does God see when He looks at me?
- What would change if I stopped performing with my possessions?

Truth summary

> God looks at my heart, not my possessions. My clothes, car, and home are tools and gifts, not a measure of my worth. I can enjoy what I have, keep it in its place, and let character speak for me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Pride
- Worldly
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Gifts, Physical/Material
- Humility

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Pride
- Money/Riches

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Truth Be Told — Matthew West featuring Carly Pearce
Honesty about struggles makes room for grace and support instead of pretending to be fine.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My clothes, car, or home show my worth"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My clothes, car, or home show my worth." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What am I trying to say with my things?
- ☐ Who am I trying to impress?
- ☐ What has this pressure cost me?
- ☐ Whom do I admire and why?
- ☐ What does God see in me?
- ☐ What could I do quietly instead of publicly?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God looks at the heart.
- ☐ My things do not show my worth.
- ☐ A gentle spirit is precious to God.
- ☐ I can enjoy my things without needing them.
- ☐ Generosity says more than appearance.
- ☐ I am enough without impressing anyone.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **1 Samuel 16:7**
  "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'"
- ☐ **1 Peter 3:3–4**
  "Your beauty should not come from outward adornment, such as braided hair or gold jewelry or fine clothes, but from the inner disposition of your heart, the unfading beauty of a gentle and quiet spirit, which is precious in God's sight."
- ☐ **Luke 21:3–4**
  "'Truly I tell you,' He said, 'this poor widow has put in more than all the others. For they all contributed out of their surplus, but she out of her poverty has put in all she had to live on.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Heart over appearance: Each week, write one moment when you chose substance over appearance.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 Samuel 16:7 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord looks at my heart, so my worth is not in my things.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Worldly" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] List what you are trying to say. Write the message you hope your possessions send.
- [ ] Pause before a purchase. Ask, "Is this for me or for the impression?"
- [ ] Notice character. Identify three people whose character you admire and what you admire.
- [ ] Share a gift. Give something of value that nobody will see you give.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My clothes, car, or home show my worth": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Heart over image
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My clothes, car, or home show my worth.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You look at the heart. Free me from needing my things to speak for me. Help me use what I have with thanks and let my character and kindness be my testimony. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #35 · WORTH AND CLASS

“Being poor means being lazy or bad.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

This belief is common because it is comforting: if poverty is always someone’s fault, then we are safe from it. It appears in family sayings, political rhetoric, and even misread proverbs. Those who have lived in poverty often absorb it too, and feel shame for a situation shaped by many forces such as illness, lost jobs, family needs, education, and bad luck.

What Scripture teaches

Proverbs does say that diligence is rewarded, but Scripture also says that whoever oppresses the poor taunts their Maker, and whoever is kind to the needy honors Him. Jesus said, “Blessed are you who are poor, for yours is the kingdom of God.” James asks whether God has not chosen the poor of this world to be rich in faith. Jesus said that whatever we did for the least of these, we did for Him. Poverty is not a verdict on character, and the poor are close to God’s heart.

> *“Whoever oppresses the poor taunts their Maker, but whoever is kind to the needy honors Him”* (Proverbs 14:31).

Also see

> “Looking up at His disciples, Jesus said: ‘Blessed are you who are poor, for yours is the kingdom of God.’” (Luke 6:20).

> “Listen, my beloved brothers: Has not God chosen the poor of this world to be rich in faith and to inherit the kingdom He promised those who love Him?” (James 2:5).

> “Kindness to the poor is a loan to the LORD, and He will repay the lender” (Proverbs 19:17).

> “And the King will reply, ‘Truly I tell you, whatever you did for one of the least of these brothers of Mine, you did for Me.’” (Matthew 25:40).

Common self-statements

- If I were not lazy, I would not be poor.
- Poor people just need to try harder.
- I am to blame for my situation.
- Being poor is my fault.
- People think poor people are bad.
- I should be ashamed of needing help.

Common logical errors

- Fundamental attribution error: Blaming character for what is shaped by circumstances.
- Just-world thinking: Believing that people always get what they deserve.
- Personalization: Blaming myself for forces beyond my control.
- Overgeneralizing: Treating one group as all alike.

Challenging questions

- What factors beyond effort shape a person’s finances?

- Do I know people who work hard and are still poor? What does that tell me?
- Where did I learn that poverty equals laziness?
- What does God say about the poor and about those who judge them?
- How has this belief affected how I treat others or myself?
- What would more compassion look like?

Truth summary

> Poverty is often shaped by illness, job loss, family needs, education, and many things beyond a person's control. God honors the poor and calls us to kindness. I can take responsibility for what is mine to do, without carrying a verdict of laziness or badness.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Poverty
- Judgmental
- Prejudice
- Giving
- Love, For Others

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Judgmental
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

Forever — Kari Jobe
Christ's resurrection grounds hope in His victory over sin and death.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus — Keith and Kristyn Getty
This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Being poor means being lazy or bad"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Being poor means being lazy or bad." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What factors shaped my situation?
- ☐ Where did I learn this belief?
- ☐ How do I treat people in need?
- ☐ What does God say about the poor?
- ☐ What would compassion look like for me?
- ☐ What is one practical act of kindness?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Poverty is not a verdict on character.
- ☐ God honors the poor.
- ☐ Kindness to the needy honors God.
- ☐ Effort matters, and so do circumstances.
- ☐ I can take responsibility without self-blame.
- ☐ Compassion is stronger than judgment.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Proverbs 14:31
  "Whoever oppresses the poor taunts their Maker, but whoever is kind to the needy honors Him."
- ☐ Luke 6:20
  "Looking up at His disciples, Jesus said: 'Blessed are you who are poor, for yours is the kingdom of God.'"
- ☐ Matthew 25:40
  "And the King will reply, 'Truly I tell you, whatever you did for one of the least of these brothers of Mine, you did for Me.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Compassion and responsibility: Each week, note one time you chose compassion over judgment, for yourself or someone else.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Proverbs 14:31 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God honors the poor, so I can leave behind the label of lazy or bad.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Poverty" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] List the factors. Write the circumstances that shaped your situation or someone you know.
- [ ] Replace the label. Write a fair description in place of "lazy" or "bad."
- [ ] Practice kindness. Do one practical act of kindness for someone in need.
- [ ] Pray Proverbs 14:31. Ask God to shape your view of the poor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Being poor means being lazy or bad": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Compassion over judgment
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Being poor means being lazy or bad.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You honor the poor. Forgive me for the times I have judged, and free me from the shame that says poverty means I am bad. Give me compassion for myself and others and wisdom for the steps I can take. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.